

## **Thematic Unit: Exploring Global Cultures Through Festivals**

Semester : Fall 2024

Student : 17

### **Unit Description**

This unit is designed for Academic AA students with intermediate-level English proficiency, corresponding to the **Intermediate Mid to High level** on the ACTFL proficiency scale. The unit focuses on improving interpretive, interpersonal, and presentational communication skills through the exploration of global cultural festivals.

### **ACTFL Standards Addressed:**

1. **Communication:** Students will engage in interpretive reading, interpersonal speaking, and presentational writing.
2. **Cultures:** Gain insights into cultural perspectives by studying global festivals.
3. **Connections:** Use authentic resources to connect language learning to real-world contexts.
4. **Comparisons:** Compare cultural practices and perspectives across different communities.
5. **Communities:** Use language skills in culturally relevant contexts.

### **Instructional Objectives**

1. Develop vocabulary related to cultural events and festivals.
2. Enhance interpretive reading skills through authentic texts about global festivals.
3. Strengthen interpersonal communication through group discussions and presentations.
4. Apply presentational writing skills to describe and analyze cultural events.
5. Utilize technology tools to support language learning and collaboration.

### **Lesson Plan 1**

#### **Reading – Exploring the Lantern Festival**

Level of Class: Academic AA

Proficiency Level: ACTFL Intermediate Mid to High

Theme of the Lesson: Lantern Festival in Asia

### **Objectives**

Terminal: Enhance interpretive reading skills by analyzing a text about the Lantern Festival.

Enabling:

1. Identify main ideas and supporting details (Interpretive Communication).
2. Understand and use vocabulary related to festivals (Connections).
3. Apply reading strategies such as skimming and scanning to locate specific information.

### **Materials**

Reading passage about the Lantern Festival (Ereading Worksheets or authentic text).  
 Vocabulary matching worksheet (Quizlet set).  
 Comprehension questions (Quiz on ELC Canvas).  
 Projector or smartboard for class discussion.  
 Symbaloo for organizing resources.

### **Timing of Activities: 65 minutes**

### **Lesson Procedure**

Warm-Up (5 minutes): Show a short video from BBC Learning English or CNN Ten about the Lantern Festival to activate prior knowledge (Interpretive Communication).  
 Introduction (5 minutes): Explain objectives and connect the topic to cultural practices (Cultures).  
 Presentation (15 minutes):

1. Students read the passage individually, using skimming and scanning strategies.
2. Discuss and clarify vocabulary using a Quizlet set (Connections).  
 Practice (20 minutes):
3. Complete comprehension questions on Google Forms (Interpretive Communication).
4. Discuss cultural comparisons between the Lantern Festival and a local festival in pairs (Interpersonal Communication).  
 Evaluation (10 minutes): Review comprehension quiz responses and discuss as a class (Interpretive and Interpersonal Communication).  
 Application (10 minutes): Create a mind map summarizing the Lantern Festival using MindMeister (Presentational Communication).

### **Means of Assessing Objectives**

Comprehension quiz results, participation in discussions, and the quality of the mind map.

### Rubric for the Lesson Plan

| Criteria               | Excellent (10 points)                               | Good (8 points)                       | Needs Improvement (5 points)          |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Comprehension Accuracy | All comprehension questions answered correctly with | Most comprehension questions answered | Some comprehension questions answered |

|                  |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                 |                                                                                           |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                  | insightful connections to the text.                                                                            | correctly, with a few minor errors.                                                             | correctly but lacks depth or significant errors.                                          |
| Vocabulary Usage | Accurately uses all target vocabulary words with contextually appropriate examples in discussion and writing.  | Uses most target vocabulary words correctly with occasional minor mistakes in context or usage. | Uses few target vocabulary words correctly; often struggles with meaning and context.     |
| Participation    | Actively engages in all class activities, collaborates effectively with peers, and contributes valuable ideas. | Participates in most activities with good collaboration and contributions.                      | Limited participation in activities; minimal collaboration or contributions to the group. |
| Application      | Creates a well-organized and insightful mind map demonstrating deep understanding of the topic.                | Mind map is mostly organized and shows a good understanding of the topic.                       | Mind map is incomplete or disorganized and lacks depth of understanding.                  |

### Contingency Plan

1. **If students struggle with the reading passage:** Provide a simplified version of the text using *Breaking News English* or adjust the reading task to focus on smaller, manageable sections with guiding questions.
2. **If technology is unavailable:** Print hard copies of the Quizlet vocabulary set and Google Forms comprehension questions. Conduct discussions and vocabulary reviews using the whiteboard or a projector.
3. **If students finish early:** Ask them to research and share facts about a local or favorite festival and compare it with the Lantern Festival in small groups.

### Lesson Plan 2

#### **Listening and Speaking – The Rio Carnival**

Level of Class: Academic AA

Proficiency Level: ACTFL Intermediate Mid to High

Theme of the Lesson: The Rio Carnival

## Objectives

Terminal: Improve listening and speaking skills through an exploration of the Rio Carnival.

Enabling:

1. Listen for specific details in an audio clip (Interpretive Communication).
2. Engage in group discussions comparing cultural festivals (Interpersonal Communication).

## Materials

Audio clip from Randall's ESL Cyber Listening Club or authentic resource.

Discussion prompts (BusyTeacher.org).

Kahoot quiz for listening comprehension.

Vocabulary flashcards (Quizlet).

**Timing of Activities: 65 minutes**

## Lesson Procedure

Warm-Up (5 minutes): Show a Peachie Speechie YouTube video on the Rio Carnival to build interest.

Introduction (5 minutes): Explain the objectives and importance of understanding cultural diversity (Cultures).

Presentation (15 minutes):

1. Play the audio clip twice; students take notes on key details.
2. Discuss main points using Kahoot quiz questions (Interpretive Communication).

Practice (20 minutes):

3. Students compare the Rio Carnival to a festival in their culture during group discussions (Interpersonal Communication).

Evaluation (10 minutes): Summarize group discussions orally to the class (Interpersonal Communication).

Application (10 minutes): Record a short video comparing the Rio Carnival with a local festival and upload it to Symbaloo (Presentational Communication).

## Means of Assessing Objectives

Kahoot quiz results, participation in group discussions, and video content quality.

### Rubric for Lesson Plan 2

| Criteria                | Excellent (10 points)               | Good (8 points)                  | Needs Improvement (5 points)     |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Listening Comprehension | Accurately answers all questions in | Answers most questions correctly | Answers some questions correctly |

|                  |                                                                                                               |                                                                                            |                                                                                        |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                  | Kahoot quiz with detailed notes demonstrating deep understanding.                                             | with notes reflecting a good understanding.                                                | but notes are incomplete or unclear.                                                   |
| Group Discussion | Actively contributes insightful and relevant ideas to the discussion, engages peers, and encourages dialogue. | Participates in the discussion with relevant ideas but engagement is moderate.             | Limited participation in the discussion with minimal or repetitive contributions.      |
| Video Content    | Creates a well-structured and engaging video with clear comparisons, details, and proper language use.        | Video is adequately structured with relevant comparisons and mostly accurate language use. | Video is incomplete, lacks clear comparisons, or contains significant language errors. |
|                  |                                                                                                               |                                                                                            |                                                                                        |

### **Contingency Plan**

1. **If the audio clip is unavailable:** Use a related video or podcast from *BBC Learning English* or *ESL Fast* as a substitute listening activity. Alternatively, read a short descriptive passage about the Rio Carnival aloud and proceed with the planned discussion.
2. **If students struggle with the listening activity:** Play the clip multiple times and provide guided listening questions to help them focus on key details.
3. **If students finish early:** Have them create a mini-presentation or skit about a festival from their culture and compare it with the Rio Carnival.

### **Lesson Plan 3: Writing – Create Your Festival**

Level of Class: Academic AA

Proficiency Level: ACTFL Intermediate Mid to High

Theme of the Lesson: Designing a Unique Festival

#### **Objectives**

**Terminal:** Develop presentational writing skills by creating and describing an imaginary

festival.  
Enabling:

1. Use festival-related vocabulary effectively (Connections).
2. Write a well-organized paragraph with a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and conclusion (Presentational Communication).

### Materials

Festival planning worksheet (Cambridge English resource).

Example descriptive paragraph (ThoughtCo).

Grammarly for peer editing.

Canva for designing a festival poster.

### Timing of Activities: 65 minutes

#### Lesson Procedure

Warm-Up (5 minutes): Use Lyricstraining to introduce festival-related vocabulary.

Introduction (5 minutes): Explain the writing objectives and relevance to cultural contexts (Cultures).

Presentation (15 minutes):

1. Analyze an example descriptive paragraph for structure.
2. Brainstorm ideas using a festival planning worksheet (Connections).

Practice (20 minutes):

3. Draft the paragraph describing the festival.
4. Peer-edit drafts using Grammarly (Interpersonal Communication).

Evaluation (10 minutes): Share drafts and provide feedback (Presentational Communication).

Application (10 minutes): Create a Canva poster to visually represent the festival and present it to the class (Presentational Communication).

#### Means of Assessing Objectives

Clarity and structure of the draft, quality of peer feedback, and creativity of the Canva posters.

#### Rubric for Lesson Plan 3

| Criteria                      | Excellent (10 points)                                                                          | Good (8 points)                                                                                  | Needs Improvement (5 points)                                                          |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Writing Clarity and Structure | Paragraph is exceptionally clear, organized, and flows logically with a strong topic sentence, | Paragraph is mostly clear and organized but may have minor inconsistencies in structure or flow. | Paragraph lacks clarity or organization and has noticeable gaps in structure or flow. |

|                           |                                                                                                          |                                                                                                 |                                                                                    |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                           | supporting details, and conclusion.                                                                      |                                                                                                 |                                                                                    |
| Vocabulary Application    | Uses a variety of festival-related vocabulary appropriately and accurately in context.                   | Uses most festival-related vocabulary correctly with minor context or usage errors.             | Uses limited vocabulary with frequent context or usage errors.                     |
| Peer Feedback and Editing | Provides detailed and constructive feedback to peers and makes significant improvements in their draft.  | Provides good feedback to peers and makes some improvements in their draft.                     | Feedback to peers is minimal or vague and little improvement is made in the draft. |
| Poster Creativity         | Creates a visually appealing and highly creative Canva poster with relevant details and artistic design. | Creates an adequate Canva poster with relevant details but limited creativity or visual appeal. | Canva poster is basic, lacks creativity, and has minimal relevant details.         |

### **Contingency Plan**

1. **If students struggle with brainstorming festival ideas:** Provide prompts or examples of unique festivals from resources like *ThoughtCo* or *Newsela* to spark creativity.
2. **If Canva is unavailable or students are unfamiliar with it:** Use colored paper, markers, and printed images for students to create posters manually.
3. **If students finish early:** Have them write a short dialogue or advertisement for their festival and present it to the class.